CONTRIBUTOR BIOS

Art by Ryan Meinerding



Prior to his triumph directing *Iron Man*, **Jon Favreau** had established himself as one of the rising triple-threat talents in Hollywood. His earliest film roles, in *Rudy* and *PCU*, highlighted his witty and engaging acting persona. With the 1996 film *Swingers*—which featured an on-screen pairing with buddy Vince Vaughn—Favreau had his breakout moment as a screenwriter. After directing the mob comedy *Made*, Favreau had a huge hit at the helm of *Elf* starring Will Ferrell, marking him as a director to watch. After starring as Foggy Nelson in *Daredevil*, Favreau furthered his Marvel credentials by guiding *Iron Man* to franchise status as one of the year's biggest blockbusters. Before returning to the film version of the character with *Iron Man 2*, Favreau even tried his hand at penning the comic book *Iron Man: Viva Las Vegas*, illustrated by Adi Granov.

Marvel Studios President **Kevin Feige** has guided the studio through more than a decade of films and was instrumental in starting up the current era of films produced directly by the studio (rather than by a production partner). Feige serves as producer for all of the studio's slate of films—including *Iron Man* and *The Incredible Hulk*, as well as the upcoming *Thor*, *The First Avenger: Captain America*, and *The Avengers*, all of which are currently scheduled to be released by 2012. In that role, it falls to him to coordinate the emergent Marvel Cinematic Universe between the different productions—drawing together a talented pool of directors, producers, actors, and artists to create a coherent film world, the likes of which Hollywood has never attempted.

Louis D'Esposito wasn't a comic book fan when he joined the production of Iron Man, and while he certainly came to appreciate the characters and concepts, he's never lost sight that the goal of Marvel is to make a good film—not just a good super hero film. After becoming co-president of Marvel Studios in 2009, D'Esposito began overseeing the entire slate of Marvel movies, including *Thor*, *The First Avenger: Captain America*, and *The Avengers*. An industry veteran, D'Esposito has served as executive producer on such films as *The Pursuit of Happyness*, *Zathura* (on which he worked with Director Jon Favreau), and *S.W.A.T.* prior to joining Marvel Studios.

As Marvel Studio's Senior Vice President, Development and Production, **Jeremy Latcham** served as associate producer on *Iron Man* and co-producer on *Iron Man 2*. With the completion of *Iron Man 2*, Latcham begins pre-production on the eagerly awaited Marvel Studios film *The Avengers*, which will bring together many of the Marvel Cinematic Universe's biggest and most popular characters.

Victoria Alonso served as visual effects producer on films such as *Darkness Falls*, *Big Fish*, *50 First Dates*, and *Kingdom of Heaven* before joining with Marvel Studios on *Iron Man*. With *Iron Man 2*, she became co-producer in charge of visual effects for all of Marvel Studios, coordinating the many VFX houses that contribute to the overall look of the film. With the effects-heavy film slate that Marvel Studios has become known for, that's no small task. Alonso is currently working on Marvel Studios' next film, *Thor*.

Mary Zophres has been a longtime—and consistent—collaborator with the Cohen Brothers, serving as costume designer on film classics such as *Fargo*, *The Big Lebowski*, *No Country for Old Men*, and last year's *A Serious Man*, in addition to movies as far-ranging as *Dumb & Dumber*, *Any Given Sunday*, *Ghost World*, and *Catch Me If You Can* (for which she was nominated for a BAFTA Film Award). In 2009, she won the Saturn Award for Best Costume for her work on *Indiana Jones and the Kingdom of the Crystal Skull*. Currently, Zophres is working on the Cohen's remake of *True Grit*.

Michael Riva came to *Iron Man* as one of Hollywood's top production designers. In 1985, he was nominated for the Academy Award for Best Art Direction-Set Decoration for Steven Spielberg's *The Color Purple*; since then, he has logged credits on dozens of high-profile films like *Scrooged*, *Lethal Weapon*, *A Few Good Men*, *Charlie's Angels*, *Spider-Man 3*, and *Zathura*, on which he first worked with *Iron Man* Director Jon Favreau. Riva won an Emmy Award in 2007 for Outstanding Art Direction for a Variety, Music or Nonfiction Programming for his work on *The 79th Annual Academy Awards*, and he was part of the *Iron Man* crew nominated for the 2009 Art Directors Guild Excellence in Production Design Award for Fantasy Films.